

Friction

Friction is a force that occurs when a solid object rubs against or slides past another, or when it moves through a liquid or a gas. It always acts against the direction of movement.

The rougher surfaces are and the harder they press together, the stronger the friction—but friction occurs even between very smooth surfaces. Friction can be useful—it helps us to stand, walk, and run—but it can also be a hindrance, slowing movement and making machines inefficient. A by-product of friction is heat.

Brake fluid reservoir

Brake fluid line

Brake lever
Rider pulls lever to brake.

Leathers

Leather clothing protects the rider from friction burns and grazes in the event of an accident.

Ball bearings

Inside the axle of a wheel, ball bearings reduce friction between the turning parts. The balls rotate as the wheel turns, making the surfaces slide more easily. They are lubricated with oil.

Tire tread

The tread—the pattern of grooves on the tire—helps to maintain grip on different types of surface.

Brake pedal

Friction between the foot and pedal maintains grip.

Fairings

On the side of the bike, fairings reduce drag.

